

Deva Anand

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Dear Pony.ai Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Software Engineering Internship at Pony.ai. Building the data pipelines, evaluation infrastructure, and algorithms behind a safe autonomous driver is exactly the work I want to do. I am an MS Computer Science student at UMass Amherst with two years of production backend experience, and my strongest work sits at the intersection of large-scale data, evaluation, and performance.

The data-pipeline side is squarely in my wheelhouse. I optimized a Spark ETL pipeline over a roughly 1.4-billion-row dataset, cutting end-to-end runtime about 25% and the analytics tail-latency ratio from 2.14x to 1.74x by reasoning through shuffle, skew, and partitioning with Spark UI. My graduate Performance Engineering coursework sharpened how I maximize throughput while keeping complexity and cost low.

Evaluation is a theme I keep returning to. I built AutoEval, an agent that improves a retrieval suite by accepting only updates that raise discriminative power on a holdout-heavy objective, with anti-Goodharting guardrails and auditable report cards. On a team KG-guided RAG project I led multi-view retrieval and ran a 4,905-question evaluation with confidence intervals, and in AgenticSearch I added an output-verification stage and 150+ automated tests. Designing evaluation metrics and testing frameworks that catch real regressions is work I find genuinely satisfying.

Underpinning this is solid engineering: I work across C++ and Python, implemented a reverse-mode automatic differentiation engine from scratch in NumPy (validated against JAX), and have graduate coursework in optimization. At Wysa I owned reliability for multi-tenant systems serving 8+ clients and 10,000+ monthly submissions and built a full-stack data annotation toolchain used daily by the AI team.

I would be excited to bring this data-and-evaluation mindset to Pony.ai, on-site in Fremont, and to learn the autonomy domain from your team. Thank you for considering my application; I would welcome the chance to talk.

Sincerely,

Deva Anand